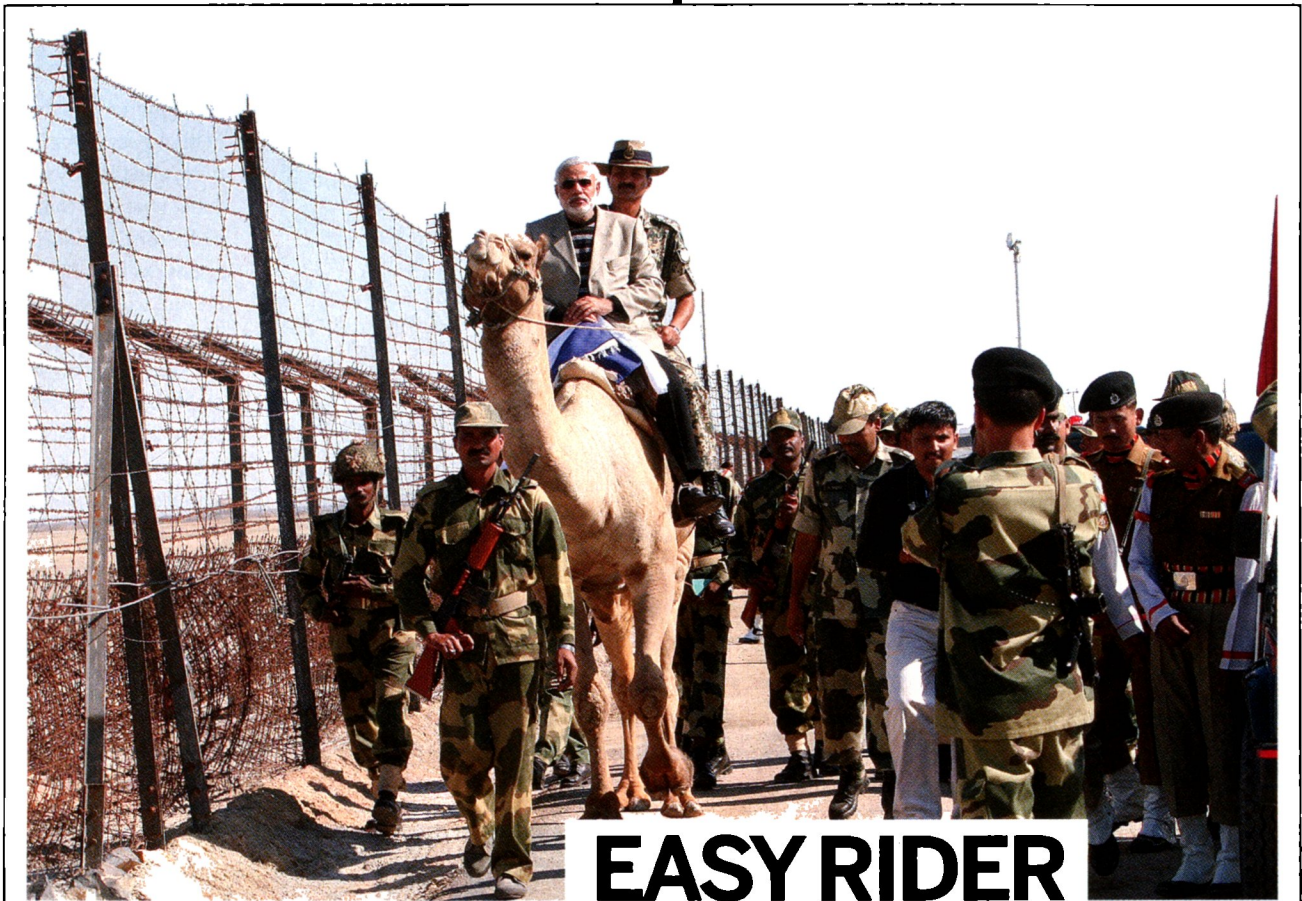




EASY RIDER

GUJARAT CHIEF MINISTER Narendra Modi's camel safari along the Indo-Pak border was his surprise new year visit to the BSF border posts in Kutch and Banaskantha. It was accompanied by promises of potable water from the Narmada dam pipeline, extended power lines and a regular supply of fresh vegetables.

PATNA | Virtual Lalu

Lalu Prasad Yadav has gone back to his childhood. Virtually. Pawan Kumar, a 31-year-old cartoonist from Bihar, is creating a virtual walk down the railway minister's memory bank. Kumar is making a 40-minute animation film that relives Lalu's childhood exploits like acrobatics on a buffalo's back, fishing frolic and ducking school all the way to his rise in politics. The yet untitled film will have Kumar's friend Shashi dubbing for Lalu. "We are a five-member team with friends from the animation industry chipping in for background score and graphics," says Kumar. "Lalu will be introduced just like the famous *Tom and Jerry* or *Mowgli*. He could even be a bigger brand," says Kumar. The cartoonist claims he has Lalu's approval for this effect. "When I showed him the clips, Laluji lauded my work," he says.

by Amitabh Srivastava



A 40-MINUTE CARTOON FILM SEEKS TO INTRODUCE LALU AS AN ANIMATION CHARACTER LIKE MOWGLI OR TOM & JERRY